6/12/13

On May 23, 2013, at the departmental retreat for the School of Community and Environmental Health, The Scholarship Working group was charged with developing recommendations for the review of faculty scholarly activity.

In June 2013, The Scholarship Criteria Working group met to discuss guidance for the review of faculty scholarly activity. The Working group quickly recognized the multi-faceted nature of scholarly activity and that the nature of review must incorporate a balanced approach among all the aspects of scholarship. There are many ways in which faculty engage in scholarship, and the various aspects of scholarship must be integrated during review to construct a comprehensive picture of the faculty member's overall scholarship as well as their trajectory. Becoming a scholar does not have only one path and one formula but rather, it is the integration of various scholarly activities. This is particularly true in the School of Community and Environmental Health because of the multi-disciplinary nature of the faculty and the fact that different disciplines have slightly different approaches to scholarship, and place a different value on various activities.

The Working Group devised a list that encompasses many of the recognized important scholarly activities among the disciplines in the School of Community and Environmental Health. These have been categorized into four broad categories. Although faculty members are unlikely to have all components listed within each category, each activity represents effort on the part of the faculty member and should be considered in evaluating the complete picture of scholarship.

It is important to note that there are many ways in which this picture can be assembled, and a careful review of all scholarly activities is the most comprehensive way to consider a faculty member's scholarship.

Currently, several activities are considered service. However, we believe these activities, such as peer review or manuscript editor, constitute scholarship as they are evidence of research/scholarly expertise and recognition in the field, and should be acknowledged as such. Many activities that are scholarly go unrecognized in the way scholarship is currently evaluated. For example, credit should be given for active participation in unfunded research and data collection design. These activities can lead to manuscripts and to the development of grant proposals. Our concern is that only counting the "final" outcome evaluation outputs, rather than process outputs, may lead to a faculty member's achievements and efforts not being properly recognized. Furthermore, the overall trajectory of scholarship of the tenure-track faculty member and his/her focused efforts should be considered. We also believe unfunded scholarship should be acknowledged given the current difficult funding climate.

Our department is comprised of various disciplines, and these are not comparable. Some of us focus on primary data collection; others on secondary; some of us develop our own instruments; and some of us may have the need to collaborate more depending on the research area. This is

important as several aspects of scholarship may be overlooked by others, especially those in another discipline or research area.

We strongly believe that quality of research, not just quantity, should also be recognized. This is why we have added categories such as impact factors and number of citations, for example.

While ODU has a research focus, it is not, at present, primarily a research institution. This must be taken into account when evaluating faculty. Faculty at ODU, if they arrive without prior funds, must start from "scratch" and spend time on forging collaborations and developing their research portfolio/track record while balancing teaching and service. The balance of this has, in our estimation, varied year to year and faculty to faculty. Thus, we have aimed to provide a more flexible framework below to take into account variations in discipline, differences in types of research, in faculty workloads and research goals, and institutional characteristics and research resources. It is important scholarship and accomplishments be considered in this operative context.

The following are scholarly activities that should be considered when evaluating a faculty member: We have also starred those areas that comprise quality over quantity and provide evidence of scholarly productivity.

Publications

- Non-peer reviewed publications;
- Expert outreach and technical reports
- Peer reviewed publications* including co-authorship
- Publication in journal with impact factor >2.5*
- Primary, second, or Senior authorship*
- Publication citation record*
- Published abstracts
- Book reviews
- Writes chapter for book
- Editorials

Presentations

- Expert outreach to non-scientists
- Co-author on presentation but not presenting
- Poster presentations at professional/scientific conferences
- Oral presentations at professional/scientific conferences*
- Invited presentations*
- Keynote presentation*

Research Projects

A) Grants

1) Developing Grant Proposals

- Collaborator on grants
- Minor Grants (<10K) as PI or Co-PI
- Major grants (>10K) as PI or Co-PI

2) Submission of grant proposals

-scoring of grant submission
-resubmission of a grant proposal

3) Secures Funding

- Collaborator on grants)
- Minor Grants (<10K) as PI or Co-PI
- Major grants (>10K) as PI or Co-PI

4) Implementation of Funded Grant

- Recruitment and data collection (primary)
- Method development and refinement
- Data management
- Project impacting policy and practice

B) Non-funded Projects

- Projects involving student guidance and participation
- Projects resulting in presentations and posters
- Projects resulting in published papers
- Projects impacting policy and practice
- Collecting pilot data/recruitment
- Preparation for funded grant proposals

Other Scholarly Activities

- Peer review of scholarly works
- Editorial Activities*
- Expert panels and boards
- Review of grant and research proposals
- Research seminars and journal club meetings
- Research appointment*

- Expert consulting and collaborations*